

Ritabrata Chakraborty

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EDUCATION

University of Pennsylvania

M.S.E. in Robotics, GPA: -/4

Pennsylvania, USA

Aug '26 – May '28

Birla Institute of Technology and Science, Pilani (BITS Pilani)

B.E. in Mechanical Engineering — Minor in Data Science, CGPA: 8.57/10

Rajasthan, India

Oct '22 – May '26

- Institute Merit-cum-Need Scholarship — Consecutive Recipient (Top 8% of Students)

PUBLICATIONS & PEER REVIEWS

Journal Publications

- R. Chakraborty and K. Kishore, “*Navigating Without Satellites: A Critical Survey of GNSS-Denied UAV Navigation.*” Submitted to **IEEE Transactions on Artificial Intelligence (T-AI)**, 2026. [🔗](#)
- R. Chakraborty and K. Kishore, “*Multi-Critic Off-Policy Reinforcement Learning for Quadrotor Velocity Control in Unknown Indoor Environments.*” Manuscript in preparation for **IEEE Transactions on Artificial Intelligence (T-AI)**, 2026.

Conference Publications

- Y. Wang, H. He, Y. Cao, J. Liang, R. Chakraborty, and G. Sartoretti, “*CogniPlan: Uncertainty-Guided Path Planning with Conditional Generative Layout Prediction.*” Accepted at **Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL)**, 2025; published in **Proceedings of Machine Learning Research (PMLR)**. [🔗](#)
- R. Chakraborty, T. Mian, and P. Kundu, “*An Efficient Approach for Synthetic Data Generation and Fault Diagnosis for Rotating Machinery.*” Accepted at **Prognostics and System Health Management Conference (PHM)**, 2025; published in **IET Conference Proceedings**. [🔗](#)
- K. Kishore and R. Chakraborty, “*Path Planning of Low-Altitude UAV for Tree Canopy Tracking and Orchard Monitoring.*” Publication awaiting intellectual property clearance, 2025. [🔗](#)

Poster Presentations

- R. Chakraborty, “*High-Velocity Impact Testing and Analysis of Layered Metal-Composite Shields Using Electromagnetic Railgun.*” Presented as poster at **Pulsed Power Science, Technology and Application (PPSTA)**, Visakhapatnam, India, Sep 2024.

Peer Reviews

- “*GS-SDE: 3D Gaussian Splatting-based Adaptive Scene Modeling in Semi-Dynamic Environments.*” Peer review completed for **IEEE Transactions on Automation Science and Engineering (T-ASE)**, 2026.
- “*Limits of Wearable Gait Analysis for Age Classification in Young Adults: Anthropometry Over Age.*” Peer review completed for **IEEE India Council International Subsections Conference (INDISCON)**, 2026.
- Selected as a peer reviewer for **IEEE Gujarat Section Conference**, 2026.

EXPERIENCE – ROBOTICS & COMPUTER VISION

Vision-Language Grounded Multi-Robot Coordination and Navigation

Supervisor: **Dr. Avinash Gautam**, Associate Professor, BITS Pilani

May '25 – Aug '25

- Surveyed literature on vision-language grounded multi-robot coordination and VLMs-based spatial representations.
- Reviewed decentralized navigation strategies fusing 3D visual-language maps with LLM-driven instruction parsing.

Multi-Critic Decomposition for Autonomous Indoor Navigation [🔗](#)

Supervisor: **Dr. Kaushal Kishore**, Principal Scientist, CSIR-CEERI

Jan '26 – May '26

- Integrated three specialized critics for forward progress, lateral avoidance, and angular alignment with distinct reward signals.
- Deployed multi-critic TD3 with prioritized replay achieving 94.2% success rate and 22% lower collision rate versus baseline.

Vision-Attention-Driven Autonomous Navigation with Semantic Understanding

Supervisor: **Dr. Guillaume Sartoretti**, Assistant Professor, MARMoT Lab, NUS

Aug '25 – Dec '25

- Enhanced **CogniPlan** with cross-attention between frontier and node embeddings to enrich node representations.
- Incorporated **Visual Navigation Transformer (ViNT)** to capture semantic context for adaptive exploration strategies.

Design and Development of Smart Automated Field Hockey Ball Launcher [🔗](#)

Supervisor: **Dr. Mani Shankar Dasgupta**, Associate Professor, BITS Pilani

Apr '24 – Oct '25

Physics-Based Launcher Mechanical Design and FEM Analysis

- Fabricated programmable launcher achieving 150 km/h using CFRP composite and stainless steel components.
- Performed FEM analysis and CAD using Fusion 360, achieving safety factor 2.07 at 496 RPM.

Computer Vision Pipeline for 3D Trajectory Reconstruction and Shot Classification

- Devised 3D ball localization from monocular videos using diameter-based depth and [PnLCalib](#) (0.76m RMSE).
- Constructed TCN-attention classifier fusing trajectory and statistical features, achieving 96.4% classification accuracy.

Uncertainty-Guided Path Planning via Conditional Layout Prediction [↗](#)

Supervisor: [Dr. Guillaume Sartoretti](#), Assistant Professor, MARMoT Lab, NUS

Mar '25 – Aug '25

- Adapted multiple image-based exploration planners into ROS pipelines for evaluation in the [CMU Exploration Environment](#).
- Supported the development and benchmarking of [CogniPlan](#), achieving up to 17.7% shorter exploration paths and 3.9% improved navigation efficiency over state-of-the-art baselines across 100+ unseen maps.

Monocular Vision-Based UAV Navigation for Orchard Monitoring [↗](#)

Supervisor: [Dr. Kaushal Kishore](#), Principal Scientist, CSIR-CEERI

Jan '24 – Feb '25

- Engineered a UAV-based orchard monitoring system using YOLOv11 (Box mAP50: 95.5%, Mask mAP50: 96.5%).
- Implemented B-spline trajectory logic and coded custom yaw-roll controller to minimize drift under wind.

Image-Based Visual Servoing for Automated Radar Control and UAV Tracking

Supervisor: [Dr. Rishi Verma](#), Head (ESDS), PPEMD, BARC

Jun '24 – Jul '24

- Established automated radar alignment using YOLOv8 and DeepSORT, improving tracking recall to 91% and speed by 13%.
- Interfaced a PLC-based actuation system enabling continuous UAV lock-in within $\pm 5^\circ$ angular error.

EXPERIENCE – GENERATIVE AI & PREDICTIVE MAINTENANCE

Synthetic Data Generation for Bearing Fault Diagnosis Under Data Scarcity

Supervisor: [Dr. Pradeep Kundu](#), Assistant Professor, KU Leuven

Sep '24 – May '26

Auxiliary Classifier WGAN-GP for Time-Series Sensor Data Generation [↗](#)

- Built ACWGAN-GP with TCN discriminator for minority fault class augmentation reaching $\sim 100\%$ classification accuracy.
- Assessed synthetic data using PCC, Cosine Similarity, MMD, and KL Divergence on FFT spectra.

Physics-Informed Generative Modeling for Bearing Fault Diagnosis Under Data Scarcity

- Formulated physics-informed cVAE-GAN and cVQ-GAN frameworks isolating latent-space effects in CWT scalogram synthesis.
- Validated [LiteFormer](#) classification gains across Density, Coverage, and CMMD metrics.

EXPERIENCE – MECHANICAL SIMULATION & BEHAVIORAL RESEARCH

Finite Element Analysis of Running Track Surfaces

Supervisor: [Dr. Mani Shankar Dasgupta](#), Associate Professor, BITS Pilani

Apr '24 – Sep '25

- Modeled surface materials using hyperelastic formulations, evaluating restitution across 3 sports disciplines.
- Proposed optimized track designs improving durability by 23% based on ANSYS fatigue analysis.

Primal World Beliefs in Engineering Students [↗](#)

Supervisor: [Dr. Rajneesh Choubisa](#), BITS Pilani

Aug '24 – Dec '24

- Conducted a primal world beliefs study surveying engineering undergraduates on core worldview dimensions.
- Replicated established population-level findings, validating trends against the original general-population study.

Impact Testing and Analysis of Metal-Composite Shields Using Electromagnetic Railguns

Supervisor: [Dr. Rishi Verma](#), Head (ESDS), PPEMD, BARC

Jun '24 – Jul '24

- Characterized 3 material configurations via the Johnson-Cook model for high-strain-rate impact response.
- Verified simulation results through railgun tests at 3.2 MJ energy, achieving $< 7\%$ deviation from FEM predictions.

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

ML Intern | Uber (AI Solutions)

Supervisor: [Mr. Siddarth Malreddy](#), Tech Lead Manager & [Mr. Ishan Nigam](#), Senior ML Engineer, Uber

Jul '25 – Dec '25

- Streamlined object annotation and tracking in [uLabel](#) for RGB/IR video pipelines.
- Applied XGBoost anomaly detection (mAP50: 75%) to flag annotation errors during validation.

Subject Matter Expert | Knowledge Cultivator

Self-supervised

Nov '23 – Feb '24

- Resolved numerical problems for student clients using MATLAB, CAD, and Python.
- Authored academic content across diverse research topics.

PROJECTS

- Vision-Guided Robotic Arm for Simulated Oral Cancer Screening** Aug '25 – Dec '25
 - Simulated a KUKA KR 150 R3100 arm in MATLAB/Simulink for end-effector guidance inside a modeled oral cavity.
 - Trained a vision model to detect cancerous regions, localizing the end effector through ORB-SLAM3 tracking.
- Autonomous Drone Navigation | MathWorks Global Student Drone Challenge 2025** Mar '25 – Apr '25
 - Designed vision-based control for Parrot Mambo drone using masking, ray-tracing, and closed-loop yaw control.
 - Optimized speed control and zone-based auto-landing to reduce track completion time.
- Air Quality Index Forecasting Using Time Series Models** [🔗](#) Nov '24 – Nov '24
 - Benchmarked AR, MA, ARMA, ARIMA, and SARIMA models forecasting daily and weekly AQI for Jaipur and Kolkata.
 - Diagnosed stationarity with ADF and KPSS tests, tuning lag orders via ACF/PACF and scoring on R^2 , MAE, and RMSE.
- 3D Lunar Surface Modeling from DEM Data | ISRO Immersion Challenge 2024** [🔗](#) Jul '24 – Jul '24
 - Created lunar terrain models from TMC DEM data with curvature extraction, rendered live in UE5.
 - Automated data import and heightmap transformation via a custom plugin, processing each tile in under 10s.
- Cricket Team Optimization | AMEX Campus Challenge 2024 (Product Track)** [🔗](#) Jun '24 – Jul '24
 - Processed and cleaned 100K+ datapoints to identify anomalies, outliers, and consistency trends.
 - Generated optimal lineups using statistical heuristics, achieving a 14% gain over baseline strategies.
- ExoMy Rover Navigation and UR3 Arm Motion Planning | ERC 2023 Remote** [🔗](#) Apr '23 – Sep '23
 - Navigated ExoMy rover using ArUco detection, Ackermann steering, and spot turns for autonomous hazard avoidance.
 - Calibrated UR3 arm with MoveIt and OMPL planner for collision-free manipulation (98% success).

AWARDS & ACHIEVEMENTS

- Finalist — Meta PyTorch OpenEnv Hackathon (India)** [🔗](#) Apr '26
- 3rd Place — MathWorks Global Drone Student Challenge 2025** Mar '25
- Finalist — ISRO Immersion Challenge (AI for Space & Geospatial Innovation)** [🔗](#) Jul '24
- Top 15 Overall, Top 5 in College — American Express Campus Challenge 2024** [🔗](#) Jul '24
- 5th Place & Best Maintenance Award — European Rover Challenge 2023 (Remote Finals)** Sep '23

TEACHING

- Teaching Assistant**
- CS F320: Foundations of Data Science, BITS Pilani* Jan '26 – May '26
- ME F218: Advanced Mechanics of Solids, BITS Pilani* Jan '25 – May '25
- ME F216: Materials Science and Engineering, BITS Pilani* Sep '24 – Dec '24
- Assisted 100+ students in labs and tutorials, clarifying concepts and linking theory to practical applications.
 - Analyzed assignments and facilitated faculty in delivering high-impact teaching sessions.

LEADERSHIP & VOLUNTEERING

- Deputy Director of Academic Programming**
- Graduate and Professional Student Assembly (GAPSA), University of Pennsylvania* Aug '26 – Present
- Vice-President**
- South Asian Association (Rangoli), University of Pennsylvania* Aug '26 – Present
- President & Secretary**
- Mechanical Engineering Association (MEA), BITS Pilani* Jun '24 – May '26
- Coordinated 10+ events and career sessions for 300+ students, facilitating technical exposure and alumni interaction.
 - Managed production of 500+ merchandise items and led outreach, boosting student participation by 20%.
- President & Tech Fest Coordinator**
- Indian Society of Heating, Refrigerating, and Air Conditioning Engineers (ISHRAE), BITS Pilani* Oct '24 – Jul '25
- Led a team of 25+ members to organize 4+ technical workshops with HVAC industry experts.
 - Hosted 3 competitions and networking events, engaging 200+ students in HVAC innovation and awareness.
- Project Manager**
- Tinkerer's Lab (TL), BITS Pilani* May '24 – Jul '25
- Supervised 5 interdisciplinary robotics teams (30+ members) on Micromouse and Hexapod projects.
 - Oversaw lab resources, conducted weekly reviews, and mentored 50+ students in hands-on technical skills.
- Treasurer**
- Bengali Cultural Association (Moruchhaya), BITS Pilani* May '24 – Jul '25
- Allocated funds and maintained financial records for merchandise sales, cultural programs, and annual events.
- Volunteer**
- Junoon, National Service Scheme (NSS), BITS Pilani* Sep '23 – Sep '23
- Organized sports and recreational competitions for specially abled children from 25+ colleges.

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Graduate Student Member — IEEE

2026

COMPETITIVE EXAMINATIONS

GRE: 317 (Quantitative: 168, Verbal: 149, AWA: 3)

2025

TOEFL iBT: 108 (Reading: 27, Listening: 30, Speaking: 23, Writing: 28)

2025

JEE Advanced: All India Rank 14372

2022

TECHNICAL SKILLS & COURSEWORK

Relevant Coursework: Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Foundations of Data Science, Applied Statistical Methods, Linear Algebra, Computer Programming, Engineering Optimization, Differential Equations, Design of Machine Elements, Digital Twins

Programming Languages: Python, C++, C, C#, Java, Bash (Shell)

Robotics & Simulation: ROS (with Gazebo, Rviz), MAVROS, Navigation Stack, MoveIt, AirSim, Unity, Unreal Engine, MATLAB, Simulink, QGIS

AI & Data Science: PyTorch, TensorFlow, Keras, Scikit-learn, XGBoost, LightGBM, OpenCV, Open3D, NumPy, Pandas, SciPy, StatsModels, Matplotlib, Seaborn, Weights & Biases (W&B), Excel

Cloud & MLOps: AWS (S3, EC2, SageMaker), Azure (Foundry), Google Cloud Platform (GCP), Docker, Git, GitHub Actions

Hardware & Embedded Systems: NVIDIA Jetson (Nano, Orin), Raspberry Pi, Arduino, IMUs, Stereo Camera, 3D LiDAR

CAD & Mechanical Simulation: ANSYS Mechanical, SolidWorks, Fusion 360

Leadership & Communication: Event Planning, Team Management, Budget Allocation, Mentorship, Cross-Functional Coordination, Public Speaking, Stakeholder Outreach, Technical Writing

Productivity Software: Microsoft Office (Excel, PowerPoint, Word), Google Workspace